

the other follow—keeping both handles in a straight line. It's not possible to make the same pointy shape possible with the cusp point.

With a symmetric anchor point, the curve handles behave similar to Newton's Third Law of Motion: "For every action, there is an equal and opposite reaction". Neither curve handle can be moved without the other moving in an equal and opposite direction, maintaining the handles at equal length but opposite in direction. Change your anchor point symmetrically to get a feel of what you can do with a symmetric one.

The smooth/tangent is a different sort of an animal. If you use it on a cusp point with two curves, it simply changes it to an asymmetric point. On the other hand, if you use it on a point with lines before and after, it does nothing. But when you use it on a point that has a curve on one side and a line on the other, it gives a smooth transition from a curve to a line by constraining the curve handle to the same direction as the line.

While editing vector images in image editors, you can manipulate the various anchor points and curve handles. Multiple points can be selected to be dragged in unison by either drag-selecting or selecting individual points.

You can adjust the curve handles in a similar fashion by dragging them in or out to shorten or lengthen them, or in a new direction to change the angle of the curve, or both. One end of the curve handle on a given point controls the portion of the segment on that side of the point. The other side of the segment is controlled by the end on the other side of the point.